

GED Social Studies Practice Test 2

PART A — QUESTIONS

GED-SOC2-001

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A city police department wants to search the apartment of a person suspected of stealing electronics. Before the search, officers present evidence to a judge. The judge decides whether there is probable cause and, if so, issues a warrant that describes the place to be searched and the items being sought.

Which constitutional protection is most directly illustrated by this process?

- A) Protection against unreasonable searches and seizures
- B) Protection against excessive bail
- C) Right to vote in federal elections
- D) Right to assemble peacefully

GED-SOC2-002

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

Under the Articles of Confederation, the national government had difficulty raising revenue and enforcing laws. When economic unrest broke out in Massachusetts in the 1780s, some leaders argued that the country needed a stronger national government. Others worried that increasing national power could threaten liberty.

Which issue does this source best show?

- A) The debate over whether slavery should expand westward
- B) The weakness of the first national government
- C) The success of direct democracy in every state
- D) The end of disputes between farmers and merchants

GED-SOC2-003

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A local market tracked the price and quantity sold of fresh strawberries.

Price per basket: \$5, \$4, \$3

Baskets sold per day: 120, 170, 230

Which conclusion is best supported by the data?

- A) Lower prices were associated with more baskets sold.
- B) Higher prices were associated with more baskets sold.
- C) The number of baskets sold stayed the same at every price.
- D) Price had no relationship to sales in the table.

GED-SOC2-004

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A family leaves a rural area after several years of crop failures and moves to a city where relatives say factories are hiring. The family expects steadier wages and better access to schools.

Which statement best identifies the push and pull factors in this example?

- A) Crop failures are a pull factor, and factory jobs are a push factor.
- B) Crop failures are a push factor, and factory jobs are a pull factor.
- C) Schools are a push factor, and crop failures are a pull factor.
- D) Relatives are the only factor affecting migration.

GED-SOC2-005

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

The Constitution gives Congress the power to impeach and remove certain federal officials. It gives the president the power to appoint federal judges with Senate approval.

Which TWO statements best explain how these powers reflect constitutional design?

- A) They create ways for one branch to limit another branch.
- B) They allow every state to ignore federal courts.
- C) They prevent federal officials from being completely unchecked.
- D) They eliminate the need for elections.
- E) They give the president sole control over Congress.

GED-SOC2-006

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Paired sources:

Source A:

A writer supports the proposed Constitution, arguing that a larger republic can better control factions because many different interests will compete. According to this view, no single group will easily dominate the whole country.

Source B:

A critic worries that a distant national government may not understand local needs. The critic argues that strong protections are needed so individual rights and state authority are not swallowed by national power.

What is the main disagreement between the two sources?

- A) Whether government should collect any taxes at all
- B) Whether a stronger national government would protect or threaten liberty
- C) Whether the colonies should remain part of Britain
- D) Whether courts should be abolished

GED-SOC2-007

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

In 1803, the United States purchased a large territory west of the Mississippi River. The purchase doubled the nation's land area and opened new opportunities for settlement and trade. Some political leaders supported the purchase, while others questioned whether the Constitution clearly gave the president power to acquire new territory.

Which issue is most clearly reflected in this source?

- A) Debate over the constitutional power of the federal government
- B) Debate over whether railroads should be regulated
- C) Conflict over joining the United Nations
- D) Conflict over ending the income tax

GED-SOC2-008

Section: Social Studies

Type: dropdown

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

An amendment to the U.S. Constitution is usually proposed by [D1] and must be ratified by [D2].

Dropdowns:

D1) two-thirds of both houses of Congress | a single federal judge | one state governor

D2) three-fourths of the states | the president alone | a majority of city councils

GED-SOC2-009

Section: Social Studies

Type: numeric_entry

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A country has 12,000,000 people and 300,000 square miles of land. What is the population density in people per square mile?

Type your answer as a whole number.

GED-SOC2-010

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A government places a tariff on imported steel. Domestic steel companies support the tariff because it may make foreign steel more expensive. Some manufacturers oppose it because they use steel to make cars and appliances.

Which conclusion is best supported by this scenario?

- A) Trade policies can benefit some groups while raising costs for others.
- B) Tariffs always lower production costs for every business.
- C) Imported goods are never affected by government policy.
- D) Manufacturers do not depend on raw materials.

GED-SOC2-011

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A state university admits students to a public program. A rejected applicant claims that the admissions rule treats applicants differently without a valid public reason. The case reaches a federal court, where judges consider whether the rule violates the Equal Protection Clause.

Which constitutional principle is the court most likely examining?

- A) Fair treatment under the law
- B) The power to declare war
- C) The right of states to coin money
- D) The president's power to appoint ambassadors

GED-SOC2-012

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A historian studies migration from the rural South to Northern and Western cities.

Period: 1910–1920, 1920–1930, 1940–1950

Estimated migrants: 500,000, 800,000, 1,500,000

Which statement is best supported by the data?

- A) Migration decreased in every period listed.
- B) Migration was highest during 1910–1920.
- C) Migration increased across the listed periods.
- D) No migration occurred after 1940.

GED-SOC2-013

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

After a hurricane, local officials organize shelters, the state government sends emergency crews, and the federal government provides disaster aid and coordination. Each level of government has a role in the response.

Which constitutional principle is illustrated by this example?

- A) Federalism
- B) Judicial review
- C) Executive privilege
- D) Direct taxation

GED-SOC2-014

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A port city grows quickly because it has a deep harbor, nearby rail lines, and access to international shipping routes. Over time, warehouses, factories, and immigrant neighborhoods develop near the waterfront.

Which conclusion is best supported by the scenario?

- A) Physical location and transportation links can shape urban growth.
- B) Cities grow only when farming becomes impossible.
- C) International trade prevents population growth.
- D) Waterfront areas cannot support industry.

GED-SOC2-015

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A jury listens to evidence in a criminal trial. Jurors must decide whether the government has proven the charge beyond a reasonable doubt. The judge explains that the accused person is presumed innocent unless the government meets this burden.

Which civic principle is most closely related to this procedure?

- A) Protection of the rights of the accused
- B) Popular election of judges
- C) Expansion of executive power
- D) State control of foreign policy

GED-SOC2-016

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

In 1848, reformers at a women's rights convention argued that women should have greater legal rights, educational opportunities, and political voice. Their declaration used language similar to founding-era documents to claim that rights should apply more equally.

Which TWO conclusions are best supported by this description?

- A) Reformers connected their demands to American ideals of equality.
- B) Reformers argued that social and legal institutions could be changed.
- C) Reformers demanded an immediate end to all political parties.
- D) Reformers opposed all forms of public education.
- E) Reformers believed voting rights should be limited to property owners.

GED-SOC2-017

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A worker's monthly rent changed over three years.

Year: 2021, 2022, 2023

Monthly rent: \$900, \$990, \$1,080

From 2021 to 2023, by how many dollars did the monthly rent increase?

- A) \$90
- B) \$180
- C) \$900
- D) \$1,080

GED-SOC2-018

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A state legislature passes a law regulating restaurant health inspections. A city then passes a more detailed ordinance requiring restaurants to post inspection grades at the entrance. The city says the ordinance addresses local public health concerns and does not conflict with state law.

Which idea best explains this situation?

- A) Local governments may exercise authority granted by state law.
- B) Cities can declare war when public safety is involved.
- C) Federal courts write all local ordinances.
- D) State governments have no role in public health.

GED-SOC2-019

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A region reports the following freshwater use.

Sector: Agriculture, Industry, Households

Water use: 62%, 24%, 14%

Which sector uses the smallest share of freshwater?

- A) Agriculture
- B) Industry
- C) Households
- D) Agriculture and Industry equally

GED-SOC2-020

Section: Social Studies

Type: dropdown

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

During the Cold War, the United States often tried to limit the spread of communism. This policy was known as [D1], and it shaped U.S. actions in places such as [D2].

Dropdowns:

D1) containment | mercantilism | nullification

D2) Korea and Vietnam | Jamestown and Plymouth | the Erie Canal and Cumberland Road

GED-SOC2-021

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A town election had the following results.

Candidate: Rivera, Chen, Patel, Morgan

Votes: 3,450, 2,980, 1,720, 850

How many total votes were cast for the four candidates?

- A) 7,000
- B) 8,150
- C) 9,000
- D) 9,850

GED-SOC2-022

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state requires citizens to register before voting. The registration form asks for name, address, age,

and citizenship status. Election officials use the information to confirm that each person is eligible and assigned to the correct voting location.

What is the main purpose of this registration system?

- A) To help election officials determine voter eligibility and polling location
- B) To allow political parties to control every ballot
- C) To require voters to explain their opinions before voting
- D) To replace secret ballots with public voting

GED-SOC2-023

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A household has \$200 left after paying required bills. The family can use the money for an emergency savings account, new furniture, or entertainment. They choose to save the money because the car may need repairs soon.

Which economic concept is most clearly shown?

- A) Opportunity cost
- B) Judicial review
- C) Naturalization
- D) Population density

GED-SOC2-024

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

During the 1950s and 1960s, civil rights activists used lawsuits, boycotts, marches, and voter registration campaigns to challenge segregation and discrimination. Many activists argued that constitutional promises of equal protection had not been fully honored.

Which statement best explains the activists' main argument?

- A) Existing democratic principles should be applied more fully and fairly.
- B) The Constitution had no connection to civil rights claims.
- C) Segregation had already ended everywhere before activism began.
- D) Courts and public protest were never used by civil rights activists.

GED-SOC2-025

Section: Social Studies

Type: drag_drop

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Match each target with the correct tile.

Tiles:

- A) Legislative branch

- B) Executive branch
- C) Judicial branch
- D) State governments

Targets:

T1) Interprets laws and decides cases

T2) Carries out and enforces laws

T3) Writes and passes laws

GED-SOC2-026

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A citizen group collects signatures asking the city to add a public transportation question to the next local ballot. The group argues that voters should be able to decide whether to approve funding for the project.

Which form of civic participation is described?

- A) Petitioning for a ballot measure
- B) Serving on a federal court
- C) Issuing an executive order
- D) Conducting a criminal trial

GED-SOC2-027

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A government plans a new highway through a mountain region. Supporters say it will improve trade and access to hospitals. Critics warn that it may damage forests and disrupt communities that depend on local tourism.

Which statement best summarizes the geographic issue?

- A) Infrastructure decisions can create both economic benefits and environmental or social costs.
- B) Mountain regions never need transportation systems.
- C) Tourism cannot be affected by land-use decisions.
- D) Highways eliminate all environmental concerns.

GED-SOC2-028

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A senator refuses a gift from a company that is affected by a bill the senator will vote on. The senator explains that public officials should avoid conflicts between private benefit and public duty.

Which civic principle is best reflected in the senator's action?

- A) Ethical conduct in public service

- B) Trial by jury
- C) Popular referendum
- D) Military command authority

GED-SOC2-029

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

During the Great Depression, unemployment rose sharply, banks failed, and many families lost savings and homes. The crisis led many Americans to reconsider the role of the federal government in economic life.

Which change was most closely connected to this period?

- A) Expansion of federal programs designed to provide relief and recovery
- B) Immediate end of all federal economic policy
- C) Complete elimination of state governments
- D) Replacement of elections with hereditary rule

GED-SOC2-030

Section: Social Studies

Type: numeric_entry

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A city spent \$48 million on road repairs last year and \$60 million this year. What was the percent increase in spending?

Type your answer as a whole number percent without the percent sign.

GED-SOC2-031

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A resident attends a town hall meeting and says, "I disagree with the mayor's proposal, but I respect that the decision should be made through open debate and a lawful vote."

Which democratic value is best shown by this statement?

- A) Respect for peaceful disagreement and lawful decision-making
- B) Rejection of all public discussion
- C) Support for rule by a single official
- D) Opposition to voting in local government

GED-SOC2-032

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

A county survey asked residents which public service should receive increased funding.

Service: Road repair, Public parks, Fire services, Libraries

Responses: 420, 260, 390, 130

Which TWO statements are supported by the data?

- A) Road repair received the most responses.
- B) Libraries received more responses than fire services.
- C) Fire services received 390 responses.
- D) Public parks received fewer responses than libraries.
- E) Road repair and fire services together received 810 responses.

GED-SOC2-033

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

The Constitution requires that the president be a natural-born citizen, at least 35 years old, and a resident of the United States for at least 14 years. These requirements apply before a person can be elected president.

What is the main purpose of this constitutional provision?

- A) To set eligibility rules for holding the presidency
- B) To decide how federal judges are confirmed
- C) To describe how states ratify amendments
- D) To give Congress power to borrow money

GED-SOC2-034

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A table shows changes in U.S. manufacturing employment in a city.

Year: 1970, 1980, 1990

Manufacturing jobs: 82,000, 61,000, 44,000

Which conclusion is best supported by the table?

- A) Manufacturing jobs increased throughout the period.
- B) Manufacturing jobs decreased from 1970 to 1990.
- C) Manufacturing jobs were highest in 1990.
- D) Manufacturing jobs stayed exactly the same.

GED-SOC2-035

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A court rules that a public school may not punish students simply for expressing an unpopular opinion in a peaceful way, as long as the expression does not seriously disrupt the school environment.

Which constitutional idea is most closely connected to the ruling?

- A) Free expression is protected, though it may have reasonable limits.
- B) Students have no constitutional rights in public schools.
- C) Only adults may express political opinions.
- D) Schools may punish any opinion that most people dislike.

PART B — ANSWER KEY + EXPLANATIONS

GED-SOC2-001 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Protection against unreasonable searches and seizures — Explanation: The warrant process helps protect people from unreasonable government searches.

GED-SOC2-002 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: The weakness of the first national government — Explanation: The source describes difficulties under the Articles of Confederation that led some leaders to seek a stronger national government.

GED-SOC2-003 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Lower prices were associated with more baskets sold. — Explanation: As the price fell from \$5 to \$3, the number of baskets sold rose from 120 to 230.

GED-SOC2-004 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: Crop failures are a push factor, and factory jobs are a pull factor. — Explanation: Crop failures push the family away, while jobs pull the family toward the city.

GED-SOC2-005 — Correct: A,C — Correct Answer: They create ways for one branch to limit another branch. | They prevent federal officials from being completely unchecked. — Explanation: Impeachment, removal, appointments, and Senate approval are checks that limit concentrated power.

GED-SOC2-006 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: Whether a stronger national government would protect or threaten liberty — Explanation: Source A favors a larger republic, while Source B worries about national power threatening rights and state authority.

GED-SOC2-007 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Debate over the constitutional power of the federal government — Explanation: The source describes disagreement over whether the Constitution allowed the president to acquire territory.

GED-SOC2-008 — Correct: D1=two-thirds of both houses of Congress; D2=three-fourths of the states — Correct Answer: D1=two-thirds of both houses of Congress; D2=three-fourths of the states — Explanation: Most amendments are proposed by two-thirds of both houses of Congress and ratified by three-fourths of the states.

GED-SOC2-009 — Correct: 40 — Tolerance: exact — Correct Answer: 40 — Explanation: 12,000,000 divided by 300,000 equals 40 people per square mile.

GED-SOC2-010 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Trade policies can benefit some groups while raising costs for others. — Explanation: The tariff may help domestic steel companies but raise costs for manufacturers that buy steel.

GED-SOC2-011 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Fair treatment under the law — Explanation: Equal protection concerns whether the government treats people fairly under the law.

GED-SOC2-012 — Correct: C — Correct Answer: Migration increased across the listed periods. — Explanation: The estimated number of migrants increased from 500,000 to 800,000 to 1,500,000.

GED-SOC2-013 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Federalism — Explanation: Federalism divides responsibilities among local, state, and national governments.

GED-SOC2-014 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Physical location and transportation links can shape urban growth. — Explanation: The city grows because of its harbor, rail lines, and shipping access.

GED-SOC2-015 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Protection of the rights of the accused — Explanation: Presumption of innocence and proof beyond a reasonable doubt protect accused persons in criminal trials.

GED-SOC2-016 — Correct: A,B — Correct Answer: Reformers connected their demands to American ideals of equality. | Reformers argued that social and legal institutions could be changed. — Explanation: The description shows reformers using founding ideals to argue for changes in rights and institutions.

GED-SOC2-017 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: \$180 — Explanation: \$1,080 minus \$900 equals a \$180 increase.

GED-SOC2-018 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Local governments may exercise authority granted by state law. — Explanation: Cities often pass ordinances under authority provided by state law, as long as they do not conflict with higher law.

GED-SOC2-019 — Correct: C — Correct Answer: Households — Explanation: Households use 14%, which is the smallest share listed.

GED-SOC2-020 — Correct: D1=containment; D2=Korea and Vietnam — Correct Answer: D1=containment; D2=Korea and Vietnam — Explanation: Containment was the policy of limiting the spread of communism and shaped U.S. actions in Korea and Vietnam.

GED-SOC2-021 — Correct: C — Correct Answer: 9,000 — Explanation: $3,450 + 2,980 + 1,720 + 850 = 9,000$.

GED-SOC2-022 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: To help election officials determine voter eligibility and polling location — Explanation: The form confirms voter eligibility and assigns voters to the proper location.

GED-SOC2-023 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Opportunity cost — Explanation: Choosing savings means giving up other possible uses of the \$200.

GED-SOC2-024 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Existing democratic principles should be applied more fully and fairly. — Explanation: The activists appealed to equal protection and democratic rights to challenge discrimination.

GED-SOC2-025 — Correct: T1=C; T2=B; T3=A — Correct Answer: T1=Judicial branch; T2=Executive branch; T3=Legislative branch — Explanation: The judicial branch interprets laws, the executive branch enforces laws, and the legislative branch makes laws.

GED-SOC2-026 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Petitioning for a ballot measure — Explanation: Collecting signatures to place an issue on the ballot is a form of petitioning and civic participation.

GED-SOC2-027 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Infrastructure decisions can create both economic benefits and environmental or social costs. — Explanation: The highway may improve access and trade but also harm forests and local tourism communities.

GED-SOC2-028 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Ethical conduct in public service — Explanation: Avoiding a conflict of interest reflects ethical behavior by a public official.

GED-SOC2-029 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Expansion of federal programs designed to provide relief and recovery — Explanation: The Great Depression contributed to expanded federal relief and recovery programs.

GED-SOC2-030 — Correct: 25 — Tolerance: exact — Correct Answer: 25 — Explanation: Spending increased by \$12 million; \$12 million divided by \$48 million equals 25%.

GED-SOC2-031 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Respect for peaceful disagreement and lawful decision-making — Explanation: The statement supports debate, disagreement, and decisions made through lawful procedures.

GED-SOC2-032 — Correct: A,C — Correct Answer: Road repair received the most responses. | Fire services received 390 responses. — Explanation: Road repair has the highest number at 420, and fire services has 390 responses.

GED-SOC2-033 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: To set eligibility rules for holding the presidency — Explanation: The listed age, citizenship, and residency requirements define who may serve as president.

GED-SOC2-034 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: Manufacturing jobs decreased from 1970 to 1990. — Explanation: Manufacturing jobs fell from 82,000 in 1970 to 44,000 in 1990.

GED-SOC2-035 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Free expression is protected, though it may have reasonable limits. — Explanation: The ruling protects peaceful expression but recognizes limits when serious disruption occurs.